of their traditional revenue models, which they were only willing to do this because of the scale afforded by the Indian market. [17]

One of the clearest examples of average Indians gaining from external partnerships is the advent of rapid transit systems in urban India. While Kolkata has had a metro rail system since the early 1980s, the recent boost to Indian public transportation began with the demonstrated success of the Delhi Metro. The Delhi Metro Rail Corporation (DMRC) was established in 1995, and construction of the rail network began in 1998. The first section of a metro line opened in 2002 and the first phase of the Delhi Metro consisting of three lines was completed in 2006. Today, the Metro network is in the world's top 10 by length and ridership. The Delhi Metro has also become a model for other cities, with dozens more transit systems in operation or under construction, and even more are being planned.

But the construction of the Delhi Metro, particularly in such a short amount of time, would have been impossible without external contributions. The Japan International Cooperation Agency (JICA) supported 60 per cent of the costs of Phase I, 54 per cent of the costs of Phase II, and 49 per cent of the costs of Phase III through soft loans. The trains were initially built in South Korea by Hyundai Rotem along with Mitsubishi, with subsequent manufacturing of rail compartments in India enabled by technology transfers. A newer generation of vehicles was manufactured by Canadian-based firm Bombardier in Germany, with manufacturing once again moving to India. The entire Delhi Metro enterprise benefited from partnerships with, among others, British construction firms, US software companies, German electronic automation, and even personnel training from Hong Kong's Mass Transit Railway. Thus, a very Indian project—one that has led to replication and services millions of people daily—was in fact a very international initiative. [18] Ultimately, what the examples from India's education, agriculture, health, telecommunications, and transportation sectors show is that in an increasingly globalized world India's national interests are inescapably international in nature.

India is not the only rising power that benefited from such external partnerships; indeed most have. The United States took advantage not just